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ITAI 2372

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AI in Entertainment and Media: Module Reflection

❖ Industry Overview

- The entertainment and media industry is responsible for creating and sharing the content that people consume every day. This includes movies, TV shows, music, video games, social media, journalism, streaming platforms, and digital art. It serves a wide range of people, from casual viewers and listeners to businesses that use media to advertise and connect with customers.
- Entertainment and media play a huge role in modern life. Most people interact with some form of media every single day, whether they're watching Netflix, listening to Spotify, scrolling through social media, or reading articles online. As technology keeps evolving, the industry is constantly finding new ways to create content, reach audiences, and improve the user experience.
- AI has become a major part of this industry because it helps creators produce content faster, allows companies to personalize user experiences, and opens up new creative possibilities. AI is changing not only how people consume entertainment but also how it gets made behind the scenes, which is why entertainment has become one of the most visible examples of AI's growing impact on society.

❖ Current AI Trends

- One of the biggest ways AI is being used in entertainment today is through content creation. Tools like GPT-4 can generate written content for articles, scripts, blog posts, and social media. These tools help writers get past creative blocks, brainstorm ideas, and handle more repetitive writing tasks. Human creativity is still essential, but AI has become a genuinely useful assistant throughout the writing process.
- AI is also transforming the music industry. Tools like AIVA, Amper Music, Suno, and UDIO can generate original music from user prompts, producing melodies, harmonies, and even full songs in just a few minutes. One example from the

readings that really stuck with me was The Beatles' "Now and Then," which used AI to isolate John Lennon's voice from an old demo so the band could finish the song decades later. It was interesting to see AI being used to preserve and restore music rather than just create something new from scratch.

- AI is also making an impact in art and design. Tools like Artbreeder and DeepArt let users create original artwork, edit images, and experiment with different styles. Designers can use AI to generate ideas and develop concepts faster than before, while also making art creation more accessible to people without formal training.
- Personalized recommendations are another major trend. Platforms like Netflix, Spotify, and Amazon Prime rely heavily on AI to suggest content users are likely to enjoy based on their viewing habits, listening history, and ratings. Spotify's Discover Weekly is a good example of how effective these recommendation systems can be. These systems improve the user experience while keeping people engaged with the platform.
- Deepfake technology is also growing quickly. AI can now generate realistic videos, voices, and images that closely resemble real people. While this has uses in special effects and creative projects, it has also raised concerns about misinformation and how difficult it's becoming to tell real content from AI-generated content.

❖ Ethical Implications

- Even though AI offers a lot of exciting opportunities, it also raises some real ethical concerns. One of the biggest is ownership and authorship. When AI creates a song, image, or piece of writing, it's not always clear who actually owns the final product. Questions around intellectual property are becoming more important as AI-generated content becomes more common.
- Privacy and consent are also major concerns. The readings touched on how AI has been used to recreate deceased actors and even digital versions of deceased family members. While some people see this as a meaningful way to preserve memories, it raises the question of whether it's ethical to recreate someone's likeness without their direct permission. Those examples made me think about who actually has the right to control a person's image and voice after they've passed away.
- Job displacement is another issue worth taking seriously. AI can now assist with tasks that writers, musicians, artists, and editors traditionally handled on their own. While it can help professionals work more efficiently, some people worry automation could reduce opportunities for creative workers. New roles in AI development and content moderation may emerge, but finding a balance between innovation and protecting creative careers will still be important.

- Transparency is something that stood out to me as well. As AI-generated content becomes more realistic, audiences may not always know whether something was made by a human or a machine. This gets especially concerning with deepfakes. If people can't tell what's real, trust in digital media could start to break down, which is why clearer disclosure requirements will likely become necessary.

❖ Future Trends

- Over the next five to ten years, I think AI is going to become even more embedded in the entertainment industry. AI-generated music, artwork, videos, and written content will likely keep improving and become a normal part of the creative process. Rather than replacing creators entirely, AI will probably serve more as a creative partner that helps people generate ideas and work more efficiently.
- Personalized recommendations will likely get even more advanced. Streaming platforms may develop systems that can predict user interests with greater accuracy and adjust recommendations in real time, creating entertainment experiences that feel truly unique to each person.
- Virtual influencers and AI-generated personalities are another trend that will keep growing. These digital characters already exist on social media, and future versions will likely become more realistic and interactive, giving companies new ways to market products and engage with audiences.
- There's also the possibility of fully AI-generated entertainment experiences where people can customize movies, playlists, or video game storylines based on their preferences. AI could create interactive experiences that adapt in real time, making entertainment more personalized than ever.
- Deepfake technology will also keep advancing, which could bring exciting opportunities in film production but will also increase concerns around misinformation and unauthorized use of someone's likeness. Stronger regulations will likely become necessary as these risks grow.
- Finding the right balance between innovation and responsibility will ultimately shape the future of entertainment. AI has incredible potential, but it has to be used in ways that respect privacy, transparency, and ethical standards.

❖ Personal Reflection

- What surprised me most about this module was honestly how creative AI has become. Before this class, I mostly thought of AI as something used for data analysis or powering chatbots. I didn't realize it could compose music, generate art, write stories, and recreate voices that sound remarkably human.

- The readings were probably the most interesting part of the module for me. The example of The Beatles' "Now and Then" showed me how AI can be used to preserve creative work in a really meaningful way. At the same time, the examples involving digital recreations of deceased actors and family members raised questions I had never really thought about before, like who has the right to control someone's image or voice after they're gone.
- I think I'd genuinely be interested in working in this industry because it sits at the intersection of technology and creativity in a unique way. Most AI applications we cover in class are focused on solving technical problems, but entertainment shows that AI can also be used to make art and build entirely new experiences. That combination was something I found really interesting.
- At the same time, this module reinforced how important it is to use AI responsibly. Technologies like deepfakes have real potential but can also cause real harm without clear ethical guidelines. As AI keeps evolving, I think developers, companies, and users all share a responsibility to make sure these tools are used in ways that are ethical, transparent, and respectful of others.